PART 09 — UI/UX DESIGN & HUMAN INTERFACE SPEC

Design Philosophy: Institutional Accounting Clarity & Zero Cognitive Fatigue

Frontend Framework: Next.js 15 (React 19, CSS Variables, App Router)

Primary Brand Colors: Deep UK Banking Navy (`#162D5F`) & Warm Modern Coral (`#FF7F6C`)

1. Ergonomic Vision & Philosophy (Non-Technical Explanation)

Bookkeepers and accountants spend 8 to 10 hours a day staring at financial tables. Traditional software often causes eyestrain with cluttered interfaces, tiny text, and unpredictable layout shifts.

blynt's interface is designed around three ergonomic principles:

1. **Vertical Alignment of Pennies:** In standard fonts (like Times New Roman or Calibri), the digit `1` is narrower than the digit `8`. If you list numbers vertically, the decimal points wobble, forcing the human eye to work harder to verify columns. blynt forces **Tabular Figures** (`tabular-nums`), so every digit occupies the exact same horizontal width. Decimal points align in a straight vertical line.
2. **Instant Visual Feedback:** While entering debit and credit rows, a floating tally bar at the bottom of the screen updates in real time. If the difference is even one penny off, a red warning badge indicates the exact discrepancy. The moment debits equal credits, the badge turns emerald green and enables the "Validate" button.
3. **Calm, High-Contrast Palette:** Built with deep navy backgrounds and soft slate card surfaces, reducing blue-light fatigue during month-end closes.

2. Color System & Semantic Tokens

Token Name	Hex Code	HSL Value	Application & Meaning
`brand-navy`	`#162D5F`	`221, 64%, 23%`	Primary navigation headers, table header banners, master brand identity.
`brand-coral`	`#FF7F6C`	`8, 100%, 71%`	Call-to-action buttons, active tab highlights, primary brand accent.
`bg-canvas`	`#090D16` / `#F8FAFC`	Dark / Light	Global application background canvas.
`card-surface`	`#111827` / `#FFFFFF`	Dark / Light	Elevated data cards, slide-over panels, journal data tables.
`border-subtle`	`#1F2937` / `#E2E8F0`	Dark / Light	Table borders, input dividing lines, card outlines.

`status-balanced`	`#10B981`	`160, 84%, 39%`	Emerald green: balanced journals, active status, validated checks.
`status-error`	`#EF4444`	`0, 84%, 60%`	Red: journal imbalances, hard-locked badges, validation rejections.
`status-warning`	`#F59E0B`	`38, 92%, 50%`	Amber: soft-locked periods, draft journals, pending approvals.

3. Financial Data Formatting Standards

4. **Right-Alignment of Currency:** All numeric financial amounts must be strictly aligned to the right:

`css

.currency-cell {

text-align: right;

font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums;

font-family: 'Inter', -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, sans-serif;

}

5. **Negative Value Representation:** Negative values are displayed in red text enclosed in parentheses:
- Positive: `£1,250.00`
- Negative: `(£1,250.00)`
6. **Zero Values:** Explicitly displayed as `£0.00` (or – in dense summary tables).

4. Key Screen Blueprints

4.1 Master Journal Entry Screen (`/accounting/journals/new`)

- **Header Bar:** Journal Date picker, Auto-generated Sequence preview (`JE-2026-XXXXXX`), General narrative memo input.
- **Line Item Grid:**
- Account selector with instant nominal search (e.g., typing "1100" or "Debtors" filters the list).
- Optional Subledger contact tag (searchable customer/supplier name).
- Line narrative memo.
- Debit input field (`NUMERIC(19,4)` formatted).
- Credit input field (`NUMERIC(19,4)` formatted).
- Delete row button (`Trash` icon).
- "+ Add Line Item" button.
- **Sticky Tally Footer:**

- Left: Total Debits `£X,XXX.XXXX`
- Center: Total Credits `£X,XXX.XXXX`
- Right: Live Difference Badge (`£0.0000` = Green, `> £0` = Red)
- Action: "Validate & Post Journal" button (disabled until difference is 0).

4.2 Customer Statement Screen (`/sales/customers/[id]/statement`)

- **Customer Profile Header:** Registered legal name, UK VAT number, company number, payment terms (e.g., "Net 30 Days").
- **Date Range Selector:** Quick filters ("This Financial Year", "Last 30 Days", "All Time").
- **Chronological Statement Table:**
- Date | Reference # | Description | Debit (Invoices) | Credit (Payments) | Running Balance
- **Statement Summary Card:**
- Total Invoiced (YTD) | Total Paid | Current Balance Due | Overdue Balance (> 30 Days).
- **Export Action:** "Download PDF Statement" & "Email Statement to Customer".